

TNA

A racier wrestling franchise, Total Nonstop Action, that features a group called Beautiful People, three girls who wear tiny mini skirts and wag their behinds when they enter the ring, asking the cameras to zoom in. TNA has recently signed on former WWE star Hulk Hogan. Aired in India on Star Sports.



VH1

MTV's older cousin, VH1, features celeb reality shows such as *The Hills* and ghetto-based competitions like *Yo Mama*, where contestants are urged to abuse each other's mothers. On *The Hills*, words such as douchebag and slut are exchanged routinely. Drugs and sex are routine.

Advertisements



Manforce condoms, featuring a popular song, *Pehli nazar mein*. Or Unwanted i-pill, with two popular TV couples, Shilpa Saklani and Apoorva Agnihotri, and Tanaaz and Bakhtiyar Irani. All aired at prime time.

Racy Rap

Yesterday's Madonna is today's Lady Gaga. And yesterday's rock 'n' roll is today's rap, a seamless world of sexist lyrics and morally ambiguous stars such as Akon. Typical song from his *Sexy Bitch* (*Chick*), the world's anthem this summer, goes like this:
*She's nothing like a girl you've ever seen before/Nothing you can compare to your neighbourhood ho/
 I'm trying to find the words to describe this girl/Without being disrespectful*



for urban India?

Archit Goyal, 11, a Standard VI student in Jaipur, has a hand-held console Nintendo, a playstation and a wii, besides access to television and the Internet. His father Ashok, a businessman, describes his son's demand for new gadgets and video games as a craze to acquire something new. There is no discourse as yet in India on the content children are exposed to, either by parents or by schools, perhaps because technology is embraced as a cure-all in a country where it has come so late. Nevertheless, it is needed, says Arun Kapur, director, Vasant Valley, pointing out that schools effectively teach for just 190 of the 365 days. Parents have to be engaged with the digital play area, he says. "Ensure that the games are exciting without being sexually explicit or too violent. Regulate the Internet by placing software that prevents objectionable downloads. If children are addicted to the huge pool of information available dig-

itally, there is nothing wrong in it," he adds.

Which is the way Kolkata's Megha Ghosh sees it. The 15-year-old is a self-confessed computer addict. "I spend around five hours daily and my favourites are Facebook (650 friends, "I am very selective"), F1.com, song lyrics, and youtube.com," she says, adding "I was a brilliant student before Standard VII which is when I got the computer though I am not bad now, getting 80 per cent and staying up till 2 a.m. if I have to complete an assignment." Ghosh's mother, Rinki, a school teacher, says her daughter is busy 18 hours a day, studying, reading, chatting or watching TV. "But I guess you have to give it to her age. As long as she knows what she is doing and doesn't go overboard, I have no complaints," she says.

But not every child can be so wise without parental counselling. How parents respond to children who are faced with the occupational hazards of the digital domain is also important. For instance, children who accessed the online gaming site of the *Naruto* series, also accidentally clicked on Deep Throat Sakura, a free interactive porn site, where they could see Sakura giving a blow job to her partner. Or the innocent viewing of even a cricket match can expose them to ads for Manforce condoms with a popular Hindi film song as its theme and well-known TV stars declaring the virtues of an Unwanted-72, a contraceptive pill. Monica Chib, a senior consultant psychiatrist